

destructively so you can change your filter settings later, select the Smart Object that contains the image content you want to filter.

Under the Filter Gallery option, you can see a preview of the special effects filters. Apply multiple filters, turn on or off the effect of a filter, reset options for a filter, and change the order in which filters are applied. When satisfied, apply it to your image and watch the image transform before your eyes.

Let's explore some of the special effects you can create with filters. You can apply filters to individual layers or to several layers in succession to build up an effect. Ensure that the layer is visible and contains pixels for the filter to take effect. Apply a filter to an individual channel or apply a different effect to each colour channel or apply the same filter but with different settings. Apply the effects to solid-colour or grayscale shapes, to generate a variety of backgrounds and textures. You can further blur these textures. You can disguise faults, alter or enhance images, or create a relationship among images by applying the same effect to each. Use the Actions panel to record the steps you take to modify one image, and then apply this action to the other images.

Masks

If Layers are the superheroes of the world, masks are the just as important sidekicks. So what are masks? Similar to its dictionary definition, in Photoshop also they refer to applying something over an image. You can use masks over a specific area of the image too. You can use layer masks to control the transparency of that layer. Note that we are talking about the transparency of the entire layer, that can be done using layer opacity. With layer masks, you can apply transparency to only a specific part of a layer. The other option is clipping masks which use one layer to determine the transparency of another. This tool uses the bottom layer to apply transparency the above layer.

So with masks you are removing one part of the layer. So why can't you use the eraser tool? Erasers destroy the pixels. You can't bring them back once erased. You can reverse the effects of the mask tool and bring back original picture.

Colour Palettes and Picker

You can change the foreground and background colours using the colour palette. The foreground colour is used to paint, fill and stroke selections.